

Ladies + Gentlemen:

The name Egypt is a misnomer. The signification of the word is "That which troubles or oppresses." Instead of this being true Egypt has been through the long vista of centuries the victim of oppression.

From the invasion of the Hyksos, a few centuries prior to Abraham's time, down to the comparatively recent conquest by the Saracens, she has ever been, except under the dynasty of Ramasees, at the mercy of her covetous and unscrupulous neighbors.

Egypt has [^] always been a place of refuge for the hungry and the persecuted. Abraham and Lot sojourned there when the famine was grievous in their own country; Jacob sent his ten sons thither when the famine was **done** in the Land of Canaan to buy corn for his household that they all might live and not die; — and more recently Loring, Reynolds, Sibley, Field, Colston, Ward, Kennon, Lockett, Hall, Mason, Derrick and a few other hungry and disfranchised Confederates went down into the land for corn for their wives and little ones.

Having spent several years in Egypt it is presumable that I will be able to tell you a great deal that will be both entertaining and instructive. The difficulty will be not what to say but what not to say. It is the abundance and the richness, rather than the paucity of the materials, which is embarrassing.

The country itself, its topography, its climate and seasons, are all so exceptionally peculiar; and the people so different from our own in their dress, manners, religion, usages of society; in their ideas and in their modes of thought, that should I do more than touch on these various topics I would detain you longer than your patience would last.

I here offer my apology in advance for being rather prolix on the marital relations of the Egyptian. Several gentlemen who are here this evening, [^] have made a special request that I be very full and ethical on the subject. On of them having made, I imagine, a successful venture in matrimony, seems desirous of increasing his risks and responsibilities. Another — and I shall not conjecture about his condition — seems not so interested as to the manner in which or the number of times to [^] matrimonial that may be tied, but only how it may be loosened.

Egypt is a wonderful country: — wonderful in its antiquity; in its past grandeur, power and civilization; wonderful in its ruined temples and monuments; wonderful in its physical aspects.

We all know that Egypt is a very old country. We have been familiar since childhood with the fearful prophecies uttered against the land by Isaiah, Jeremiah and Ezekial. It is the land of Joseph, of Pharaoh, and of Cleopatra. Egypt is a book in which we read many holy and romantic stories illustrated with sweet touching and graceful pictures of oriental life.

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Three thousand nine hundred years before the Christian era the curtain rises, and we see Egypt, almost the solitary actor in the world's history, hoary with age, and dying from the effects of a luxurious ^{and effeminate} civilization. Antiquarians have discovered underlying that civilization evidences of other and different civilizations, the one built upon the ruins of the other, and reaching back into the impenetrable darkness of the past.

It is safe to say, relying upon the Greek historians, and upon the the modern Egyptologists who are daily throwing fresh and stronger light upon her history, that Egypt was a civilized country 57 centuries ago; its government a constitutional monarchy; its people well versed in architecture, in the finer mechanical arts; in astronomy, geometry and medicine.

Within the narrow confines of the Nile Valley there existed long before Abraham's visit two mighty empires. The ruined palaces of Karnac and Luxor, homes of living royalty tell us of the pomp and power of Thebes; and the Colossal Pyramids, homes of royal dead, attest the ancient glory of rival Memphis.

Thirty Eight centuries ago Egypt possessed at its imperial city of Heliopolis a great university. Under the shadow of its walls lived Joseph who had married the daughter of the high-priest of its temple. Moses was educated in it. Afterwards there came to learn the wisdom and sciences of the Egyptians, Euclid, Eudoxus, Pythagoras, Plato, Heroditas, and many other illustrious personages of ancient history.

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The grand age of Egypt was about the time of Moses. She was then one great centralized power. Her population upon an habitable area one-sixth that of Georgia, numbered eight millions of people.

Ramasees, the greatest of the Pharaohs had conquered and annexed Ethiopia, Arabia, Syria, Mesopotamia and the islands of the Levant. Her armies conquered, her scholars instructed, and her agriculture fed the then known world; while the solemn, gloomy rites of her mystic religion captivated the imagination and enthralled the mind of man.

The arts and sciences seemed to have flourished long before this period. Certain it is that some of the greatest monuments of her power and skill were constructed many centuries before.

Of these monuments I shall mention two — the Great Pyramids of Cheops, and the obelisk— one of the numerous so-called needles of Cleopatra— which has just been taken to London and set up on the banks of the Thames.

It is scarcely possible to mention the name of Egypt without creating in the mind a picture of the Pyramids. They have been so often written of that I shall not weary you with a description of them. I will simply mention a few facts ~~connected~~ concerning the largest one of them, hoping to present them in such a manner as will enable you to realize the patience, the skill, the genius, and the power of those who constructed them.

The mere stating of the dimensions of the Great Pyramid, viz: 472 feet high, with a base of 768 feet square, fails to impress it upon the mind. We come a little nearer its conception when we know that it covers 138 acres of ground. Let us imagine one of the individual stones of this stupendous structure, — one of them alone to speak,— for it is only by the examination of it that the mind can grasp the whole.

Some of these stones, cut out of solid hard-grained rock of cubical form, weigh 1800 tons! Can you imagine such a stone? Can you conceive the mass of it, after knowing its weight? Supposing it to be cut up into block of convenient size, it would require four railroad trains of forty five cars each loaded to their full capacity to transport it. The modern engineer who having such a stone at hand, could lift it from the ground any ⁱⁿconsiderable height, and put it into position would gain no little reparation.

Conceive the magnitude of the undertaking of quarrying one of these stones,— one of these infinitesimal parts— the transportation of it for miles across a rising sandy desert, and finally the lifting it higher than any church-steeple in Augusta, and putting it into its place with mathematical precision.

Again, there is enough material in the Pyramid to construct a solid wall 2 $\frac{1}{4}$ feet thick and 3 feet high along our entire British American and Mexican frontiers; and this after having furnished the Caliphs with the material for building the great city of Cairo.

I desire to call your attention to that other monument that we may compare

the ancient Egyptian engineers with those of perhaps the richest and greatest nation of the present day.

This obelisk is associated with the history of three of the most dazzling and romantic characters in Egyptian history. Thotmes III the greatest monarch of a great dynasty caused it to be quarried at Assuan, brought it to the boats of the Nile; floated 700 miles down the river; finally setting it up in front of the Temple of the Sun at Heliopolis in commemoration of a great religious festival recurring once in 30 years.

Several centuries later, Ramasees the greatest of Egyptian heroes and conquerors inscribed, upon its faces in mysterious hieroglyphics the glories of his reign.

Twelve centuries passed, and Cleopatra had it removed to her capital city of Alexandria and placed it in front of a temple which she founded in honor of her deified lover Caesar.

Nearly 2000 years after this it was presented by the Vice-Roy of Egypt to the British Government. It was then lying at Alexandria only a few feet from the water's edge and convenient for shipment. England made two unsuccessful attempts to carry it away at the beginning of the present century. For 75 years British engineers have looked at this prostrate column, 70 feet long by 7 ½ at the base weighing 200 tons, confessing their inability to handle it; though Egyptian engineers thousands of years ago transported it hundreds of miles across mountains and over deserts, floating it down rivers, setting it up and taking it down at pleasure.

Two years ago, after many accidents the column was set up in the bank of the Thames; and the English people think it a great triumph of engineering skill. Now does it not seem when we compare the two people by the light of the obelisk, in their particular branch of science, that the ancient Egyptian was immeasurably superior to the Englishman of today.

I have said Egypt was a wonderful country in its physical aspects. It is a rainless country without springs and without wells; yet none is better applied with water for animal or vegetable life. Thunder and frost are unknown, and for a greater part of the year not a cloud is seen. The most delicate hygrometer rarely detects the slightest trace of moisture in the atmosphere; so that one imagines himself comfortable—in the shade—with the thermometer over 100°, and freezing—in the wind—when at 50°.

And what can be more wonderful than the Nile, or the Great Desert?—the good and the evil spirits of Egypt,—or the mighty conflict continually going on between them?

If you will watch the sun as it travels north you will find that on the day it touches the Tropic of Cancer this singular river begins to swell; Sometimes it is a few days ~~late~~ earlier and sometimes a few days later; but the longest day of the year generally announces the beginning of the rise.

As long as the sun remains in the Northern Hemisphere the current continues to swell; but where it crosses the Equator,

it is a signal for the waters to stand still and to retire. No storms, no rains, no clouds herald the inundation. Bright skies and a gentle steady north wind accompany it from beginning to end.

This rise the Egyptian believes to be caused by a miraculous drop which falls into the river. The commencement of the rise, and the day it attains a good height, are seasons of great rejoicings. The precise moment when the drop is to fall is calculated by astrologers. Many of the inhabitants of Cairo and of the provinces spend the night on the boats of the river. The height of the rise is proclaimed daily. In the different quarters of Cairo is a Crier of the Nile, who goes through the streets early in the morning with the announcement that "God hath been propitious to the lands". When the rise reaches the average high-water mark he announces that "the River hath given abundance and completed its measure. God hath filled the canals".

The Great Desert controls the climate. The popular conception of the Desert is perhaps erroneous. It is not by any means a flat level sandy plain. It is broken into mountains, valleys and plains— but it is all sand and rock.

In its silence and desolation it is awful and sublime. Day or night not a living sound is heard—not the note of a bird, not the chirp of a cricket, nor the lazy buzz of an insect.

The great Desert is the immediate cause of a very singular and dreadful wind. This wind is spoken of in the Bible as the "vehement East wind". It prevails to this day and is called the "Khamseen". Its seasons are as well marked as the movement of the Nile. It comes hot and burning from the fiery sands of the Lybian Desert. During its prevalence the air is filled with clouds of fine sand, which finds its way through the tightest door and into the eyes, nose, mouth, and throat. The sun looks unnaturally red. The external heat is higher than that of the body; hence to keep cool one must wrap up in a blanket. Metal substances lying upon your table become too hot to be held in the hand. New sand hills rise in the desert, and old one disappear. Sand drifts fill up canals and railroad cuts at exposed ~~places~~ points. The desert makes a general advance along the lines and retakes a portion of the ground recently held and fortified by the Nile.

The stoppage of the Pelusium branch of the Nile ages ago ^{by the drifting sands} has converted large tracks of fertile lands lying near the present Suez Canal, into barren sandy plains.

It was my good fortune to be caught out in one of these winds. I say good fortune only because it added to my stock of experience.

It was during a Surveying expedition in the old Land of Goshen. We were two miles from camp when it came upon us. The instruments were so expanded by [^] the heat as to become useless; and our camels uttered the cry of distress.

But judging from my experience I do not think

Jonah was justifiable either in getting mad, or fainting or wishing he was dead when he was overtaken by a similar wind.

But let us leave the past and come down to the modern Egyptian Empire ruled over by the new Khedive, Mohomet-Tewfik.

I cannot let this occasion pass without saying a word in vindication of a very good and very remarkable man. Ismail-Pacha, the late Khedive is a gentleman; a man with a big heart and a big soul; a man of noble ambitions, generous; hospitable; true in his word and promises. His great aim was to educate his people and to bring Egypt up to the standard of European civilization, laying the foundation of a great African Empire. He was a prince who felt his responsibilities; a hard-working industrious man who devoted his energies to the best interest of his people. Opposed by his own countrymen feared by the Sultan, intrigued against by the Great Powers, his position was surrounded by peculiar difficulties.

When he entered the European polity he fell into a den of thieves. Christian princes called his cousin and borrowed his money. The late king of Italy who died bountiful owed him over \$5.000.000 borrowed money. Foreign rings composed of distinguished but impecunious gentlemen got up grand enterprises for the purpose of restoring their fortunes. Foreign Syndicates negotiated his bonds, seemed by the public revenue, and charged him '53 percent commission. Foreign governments specifically that of England, have aided these combinations, wanting an excuse to take possession of the country.

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They ruined Egypt and were starving her people, and when the Khedive refused longer to be their tax-gallow, he is forced to quit his throne.

Serving for more than 3 years upon his General Staff I testify to these many good qualities of heart and mind. I believe he carries with him into his exile the good wishes of every American officer who served in his army.

Egypt and her possessions constitute, in extant, a great empire; reaching through 32° of Latitude and 30° of Longitude; and embracing an area of 4,000,000 square miles, or 68 times larger than Georgia.

With the exception of the Nile Valley it is a sandy desert or an impenetrable jungle. The population of this immense tract is about 20.0000^{.000} three-fourths of it being savages of Central and Eastern Africa, and wandering Arabs of the Desert.

Egypt, strictly speaking, is nothing but a river bottom. It is all below high water mark. The great cities were built upon the uplands above high-water, and consequently upon the Desert. While the smaller cities and towns and villages of the husbandmen were built upon artificial mounds in the bottom. Until comparatively recent period Egypt was submerged for several weeks annually. But this is changed now; the river with its numerous branches and canals are all levied; and there is nothing to doubt the stranger as he dashes along on the express 40 miles an hour through rich meadows of waving corn, that he is 10 or 15 feet below the water level.

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The line separating these beautiful meadows from the adjoining desert is sharp and well defined. It is possible to make the circuit of the valley with one foot on the richest of soil, and the other on a barren sand—one foot upon Egypt and one foot upon the Great Sahara.

The population of this valley is very dense. If Georgia was as densely populated, we would number 41,000,000 of souls. It is one great and beautifully kept garden full of graceful forms and rich in colors; interspersed with clumps of date-trees, groves of oranges, figs and pomegranates; patches of cotton, wheat, corn and lentils, and thickly studded with white domes minarets and mud villages.

I wish I could leave out these mud villages. They are blot upon the picture. They tell of ignorance degradation and oppression. You never hear the laugh of playing children or the song of happy maidens. An air of silence and sadness broods over them. The amount of money that a cruel and rapacious Governor can wring out of one of these little mud villages of 500 souls and 300 acres of land is incredible. The land tax of \$3.000 is but a beginning.

The Government of Egypt, like all oriental governments is but a huge, cruel, tax gathering machine. A witty Frenchman has said that the ~~Egyptian~~ Government was composed of two co-ordinate branches—Baksheesh and Courbash:— Bribery and Flogging. An Egyptian gentleman in official stations must give presents to every body over ^{him} ^ and flog every body under him.

The Khedive by himself has been unable to arrest the current of corruption, cruelty and oppression.

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He has absolute power over the property, the liberty and over the lives of his subjects. He can cause any man, at his pleasure, to be put to death, his property taken for his own use, and in body can he found from the Nile to the Red Sea who question his right. Perhaps some of us can recal one time in the history of the U.S. when had our Khedive possessed such a right we would have taken to the bushes. It is to the honor of the late Khedive he never executed this right.

I have been often asked about the color of the ~~late~~^{Ex-} Khedive. Many suppose he is of an olive color; others the color of a dark mulatto. While not a few have been suspicious to hear that he was not black.

It will surprise you perhaps to know that there is scarcely a gentleman in Augusta who is so fair and white. He is a Turk; that is to say, of the Turkish race, the handsomest people in the world; writing the complexion of the blonde and the fair and eyes of the brunette. In stature he is low and stout; is aged 48; he speaks French fluently; is polished and agreeable. ~~In manners~~ and once in his presence you are charmed with the princely, ~~and~~ the ease and the simplicity of his manners.

He was the largest planter and the most bloated landholder in the world. He owned one and a half millions of the best land; squares of the first buildings in Cairo; two steam-ship lines; three railroads; a dozen large sugar refineries; six gorgeous palaces in Cairo, three in Alexandria; had 4 wives and 600 handmaidens; and in spite of his

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matrimonial responsibilities seemed to enjoy life.

Before speaking of the religion, usages of society and domestic life of the Egyptian, it is well to say something of the population of Egypt and something of her Capital.

The Egyptians are essentially a mixed race. **Swarth** lights are descendants of the Moslem Arabians who conquered Egypt under Mohomet's successor. The remainder are Turks, Copts, or descendants of the Ancient Egyptians, Syrians, Armenians, Greeks, Jews, Nubians, Moors, Ethiopians, Arabians, and Abyssinians, with a sprinkling of numerous other nationalities. races

From the windows of your room in Cairo you can look upon the street below and see 20 different nationalities in their native costumes and hear 20 different tongues.

In fezes, turbans, and gowns you see all the colors of the rainbow; and in complexion all shades from the blue-black of the Ethiopian slave to the fair and rosy Turk.

Mix up with these, in your minds eye, strings of camels, gaily caparisoned donkeys, fat old Egyptian Beys in big turbans, ~~and~~ flowing gowns of sky-blue silk and red morocco slippers, mounted upon stately he-asses and lovingly attended by black slaves; eunuchs upon high-bred Arabian horses; carriages preceded by running foot men in flowing white sleeves and **embraded** jackets, filled with the ladies of the Hareem of some old Blue-Beard; water carriers with their leather-bottles.—Listen to the songs of the poet-peddlers in the flowery language of Arabia

in praise of their figs, pomegranates, eggs or cucumbers, and you will have a picture of a common street scene in Cairo, rivaling the most gorgeous descriptions in the Arabian Nights.

Cairo is the most oriental city in the world,—the seat of Arab literature and learning; surpassing Bagdad in its romance, picturesque oriental wonders, in its strange sights, strange noises—strange smells.

It has 400 Mosques 2000 coffee shops where for $\frac{3}{4}$ of a cut you sip Moccha coffee, smoke perfumed tobacco in a long-stem **Chiloque**, and listen to charming improvised romances of love and war.

Among the 480.000 inhabitants it has 10,000 water-carriers, 30.000 itinerant vendors of silks, embroiderers, silver-jewelry, drugs, spices, sweetmeats, and parfumery; 3.000 pipe cleaners; 2,000 story-tellers; 5.000 letter-writers; 2,000 fortune-tellers, and 1.000 promoters of marriages. Twenty thousands donkeys save for street cars, and 8.000 camels for drays.

The streets are narrow and crooked, few of them, few of them being wider than necessary to admit a camel and his burden. They are unpaved and without sidewalks, but Egypt is a rainless country and there is no mud. Water-carriers keep down the dust, and the passing of carriages is as noiseless as the tread of the soft footed camel.

A cool dry wind is drawn through the streets as through a funnel; white coverings of plank over-head protect from the glaring sun.

In the midst of these crowded alleys are found the gorgeous palaces of the wealthy, surrounded by fairy-like gardens, where the odor of roses and geraniums + noise the

noise of falling-waters and the cooing of the turtle-doves fill the air. A high wall shuts out the outer world and allows beautiful white slaves to wander amid grateful shades undisturbed by curious eyes.

Having given you faint glimpses of his country and his capital, let me tell you something of the Egyptian himself—the average middle-class well to do Moslem.

In color he is like the sands of the Desert, from whence his ancestors came. He is above the average height; well-proportioned, muscular and robust. His nose is straight, mouth well formed lips rather thick. He has white regular teeth, a black scanty beard, and large black splendid eyes. He rarely shaves the beard, never the mustache.

His dress has remained the same for many centuries. It consists of full trousers of thin cotton stuff tied around the waist by a running string. Next a short shirt of muslin or silk. In winter he wears over this a vest of striped silk; and over the whole the Kaptan, a flowing gown of silk striped with gay colors and descending to the ankles with long sleeves much longer than the arm, but split just above the wrist that he may use or conceal his hands at pleasure, for etiquette requires him to cover his hands in the presence of high rank.

Around the waist is wrapped the soft heavy scarf or light cashmere shawl, in which he sticks his fan, his ink-horn, or his purse. His over coat is a cloth robe of bright color, blue, yellow, or red, with long full sleeves.

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which his most intimate friend never see uncovered.

On his head he wears first a white cotton skull cap, over this a red fez with a black silk tassel, lastly a long piece of white embroidered muslin wrapped round and round and forming the turban.

If he is a descendant of the Prophet, he is a nobleman, though may be a water-carrier, and wears a green turban and a bright green gown.

He rarely wears stockings and then only in winter. His shoes are of red morocco, and pointed, turning up at the toes. Under these he sometimes wears moccasins of soft yellow morocco that he may not expose his feet when he enters a house, or when he prays.

He invariably wears a seal ring, or an engraved seal suspended from the neck by a slender gold chain, for his sign-manual is not valid in law. His prayer carpet and his pipe are his constant attendants, frequently carried by a Nubian slave following close at his heels.

When he meets an acquaintance he salutes him with Salaam—~~an lakum~~—"Peace be on you," and receives in return "Salaam—~~an lakum~~"—"On you be peace and the Mercy of God and his blessings."

He is formal, dignified polite and graceful in his manners. Though rather of a cheerful countenance he never laughs, rarely smiles, and then he endeavors to give it a pious expression. He is given to salute and is fond of humor, but his twinkling eye alone detects it. When he meets you after a short interval he kisses you on both cheeks, lays his head upon your shoulder and tells you "thy absence hath made my heart desolate."

You must never inquire

after the health of his wife, unless you would put upon him a deadly insult. You must never enter his Hareem in person or in thought.

He is excessively religious. The first thing he hears when he enters the world is the call to prayer repeated in his ear by a pious Cheikh. He prays five times a day—at daylight, noon, middle of afternoon, sunset, and just after dark,—and thanks God he is neither a Christian nor a Jew.

He marries young—an old bachelor is an abomination in Egypt—and he marries often; is kind to his wives, giving them hand maidens—whether they want them or not—,divorces them when he can replace them by younger and prettier ones—and in all things endeavors to act as a faithful follower of the Prophet, and as a quiet, good citizen.

I approach the description of the fair sex with hesitation. Living the life of a bachelor in Egypt they shunned me, passed round me, and avoided me. During my whole stay in the county I was never addressed but by one native female. It was near the spot where Joseph met his father and brethren when they came down to Egypt to live.

I had stepped aside from the cattle foot path into a patch of wheat just ready for the harvest. While examining it I saw a Moslem maiden approaching on her way from the river bank to the village carrying a water-jar upon her head.

As she neared me she cast furtive glances about her. I perceived I was an object of interest to her. She placed her water-jar upon the

ground; advanced a few steps towards me. She hesitated; and then drawing aside the yashmak which concealed her comely features, she said to me in a trembling musical voice—pitched rather too high—“you are breaking down our wheat: get out you ugly Christian dog!”

Females who make any pretense to gentility are entirely secluded from male society. They can see only their fathers, brothers, husbands, and sons.

They are never to be in company with, nor to speak to, nor to unveil before any others. Two brothers living next door to each other for a life-time would never see each others' wives except as they passed in and out and then closely veiled.

The Koran requires a woman to conceal whatever may be attractive about her person or her dress from all males except the relations mentioned. Our customs are somewhat different. The word Hareem pronounced Harem with us, is applied in Egypt to the females and children of a family, and to the apartments they occupy. It is a word used in the East by Moslem Jew and Christian, and does not necessarily imply more than one wife.

The Egyptian girl is fully grown at 12 years of age. She is generally married before she is 14, and often before she is 12.

Between 14 and 20 she is exceedingly pretty in face + figure. Her eyes, which are the only features a stranger generally sees, are large, black and soft. The eyelids, both upper and lower, are colored with a black powder called Kohl which increases the ^{effect}.

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The nails and the tips of the fingers are stained with henna a deep orange color. Her [^] outdoor dress is costly and elegant but on going out it is carefully concealed by the habarah, a thin black silk sheet three yards square, the upper edge fastened to her head and the four corners held by the hands in front.

Whatever property she may get from her father, and the dower from her husband, is always invested in jewelry of solid silver ⁺, of gold, or in diamonds and other precious stones. There is hardly a peasant woman in Egypt no matter how poor, but that has one or more solid silver bracelets. It is the investment of her dower money. Moslem law forbids her putting it at interest, calling it usury; and she is too wise to turn it over to her husband. This jewelry she can always convert into money; but whatever may be, the necessity of herself or family she never parts with it reserving it for her support when she shall be divorced.

She grows old rapidly; at 25 she has lost all her beauty; and at 30 looks like a woman of 50.

When a young man desires a wife his mother or sisters describe to him all the young girls of their acquaintance; and from this description he makes his choice! Or, he avails himself of the advice and assistance of a Khatibee, or professional match-maker. She always describes an almond-eyed gazelle, young, elegant beautiful and rich.

And what very young girl could turn a deaf ear to the offer: — My daughter, the youth

youth who is languishing for you, who can neither sleep nor eat for the love that torments him, is very young, graceful, elegant, beardless; he has plenty of money, numerous servants; he dresses handsomely, is very fond of delicacies; but he cannot enjoy all these luxuries alone; he wants you as his companion; he is very pious; he goes to the Mosque every Friday, and he is constantly uttering pious exclamations; he is a stayer at home, and will spend his whole time with you, caressing you and fondling you.”

She generally manages to get a look at her future husband by stationing herself at a latticed window before which he is to pass; but he never gets a peep at her face until she is his wife. The father almost invariably refuses to let a younger daughter marry before her sister, following the example of Laban who refused to give Rachael in marriage before Leah saying “it must not be so done in our country to give the younger before the first born.”

The marriage ceremony is a very simple or a very complicated affair according to the social position of the parties.

The simplest is that in which the bride says in the presence of witnesses “I give myself up to thee.” Young girls are rarely married in this way; widows and divorced women frequently. In the provinces the bride is wrapped up in a shawl, seated upon a camel and conducted to the house of the bride-groom. Four or five of her female friends accompany her mounted upon the camel.

These rustic affairs are as simple as the marriage of Rebecca to Isaac,—who simply said, when Isaac's servant told her what a nice young man he was “I will go”—and Rebecca arose and her damsels and they rode upon the camels and followed the man.”

In Cairo a genteel wedding is an affair of a week's duration. It commences by the bride going in procession to the bath, marching behind a band of musicians, closely veiled and under a silken canopy whose corners are supported on staves held by four male servants. Behind her is her female friends and her servants. The whole day is spent in the bath feasting and frolicing. In the meantime the groom suspends lanterns of colored glass about his house and in the streets leading to it, and entertains his friends. This is kept up for several days, when he goes with a few friends to her father's house to pay the marriage dower and to conclude the ceremony.

This is performed in the following manner: —He and the bride's father, or other person who gives her away, sit upon the ground face to face grasping each other's right hand and raising the thumbs and pressing them against each other. A Fikee, or schoolmaster then gives a short sermon on marriage; after which the father says “I marry to thee my daughter the virgin Neefeesa; to which the groom replies, I accept from thee her marriage to myself, and bind myself to protect her.” This is repeated by each three times. They and the witnesses then ^{say}

say "And the blessings be on the Apostles and praise be to God, the Lord of the beings of the whole world."

She now prepares her dresses and purchases her housekeeping articles; he going [^] home without seeing her, to make ready his house. After a week's time her trunks and furniture are sent on a train of camels to his house, she bringing up the rear or arriving later in the evening. Going to her apartments and seating herself, closely veiled, on a carpet in the middle of the room, she awaits the first visit from her husband.

As he enters, her friends retire, waiting at the door. Raising her veil he says "In the name of God, the Compassionate, the Merciful"; and compliments her beauty. She replies "God bless thee."

If he is not disappointed with her he informs the women at the door who sound the zaghareet, or the cry of joy; it is taken up by the other females of the house, and often by the females of the adjacent houses who immediately come in to congratulate her on having found favor in the eyes of her husband.

Every Egyptian by law can have 4 wives at the same time. These he can divorce when he pleases by simply saying "I divorce thee." He need not assign any cause; or he may say he does so to marry another woman. It not infrequently occurs that a man has married 40 or 50 wives before he is thirty years old; and just as common for women who are still young to have been the wife of a dozen men. It is uncommon to find a man who has not changed his wife one or more times.

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An Egyptian woman looks forward to ~~death~~ a divorce as a good Christian does to death—as a melancholy but inevitable event. She lives in constant dread of it. A crusty husband finding a button off his shirt relieves the pressure by saying, Fattoome, thou are divorced.” A headachy grunting wife would find herself out of doors before she could say Jack Robinson.

When one has four wives they generally live in different houses, keeping separate establishments. The husband by law is required to divide his time equally between them, but it is easily evaded.

I am told it requires a man of rare ability to manage more than one wife living under the same roof.

One of them is generally his favorite, for whom he neglects the others. There is a continual struggle for the position. Each tries to look younger, prettier better dressed, and to be agreeable to her lord than the others. He never catches them with headaches or heartaches; they are all smiles, all compliance all sweetness

In the Mohammedan religion there are two cases in which it is not only not sinful to tell a lie, but commendable to do so. One can tell a lie to ~~please or pacify his~~ ??? friends; and he can tell a lie to please or pacify his wife.

An Egyptian friend, the husband of three wives assures me that without the right of telling lies to wives and of divorcing them, it would be impossible to get along with the women.

While a man may change his wives at pleasure, he is restrained from the exercise of the right from the fact that every woman requires a dower paid into her own hands at the marriage, and this dower she takes with her when she is divorced. Besides this a man divorcing his wife makes her family his enemies. So that the man who too frequently indulges in the luxury of a new wife soon finds himself without money and without friends.

But this divorce business is not such a one-sided affair as it may appear. A woman might marry a man for his money, stipulating in the marriage contract for a large dower. Having secured this she might desire to be free again. Now we have too much respect for the ingenuity, the tact and the perseverance of woman to doubt her ability to provoke a ^{saint} ~~sant~~ to exclaim, "Mary Jane thou art divorced."

Every Egyptian house is composed of two distinct and separate parts, the Salaam-a-lick and the Hareem. The first is for the males of a family, and the second for the women and children. In the Hareem no male is allowed to enter, but the husbands and the sons. With the wealthy the Hareem is in charge of eunuchs. Into it they have ~~access~~ authority to enter at all hours. They attend the ladies when they go out visiting or riding in the double capacity of servants and spies.

The furniture is simple but elegant. Large divans surround three sides of the room, serving as lounges during the day, and as beds at night.

Chairs are not used. Thick heavy carpets cover

the floor upon [^] which the family and their visitors sit.

Meals are served upon a large circular tray placed upon a low stool in the middle of the floor.

The husband eats in the Salaam-a-lik, generally having some of his friends to dine with him; the wife and children in the Hareem. Everybody eats from a common central dish. Fingers take the place of knives and forks. A roasted Turkey on a leg of mutton is pulled to pieces with an ease and a delicacy that is astonishing. When the host desires to be especially polite he pinches off choice little bits and put them in the mouth of his guest. All have their hats on—and their shoes off.

The first ceremony of a meal is the washing of hands. A black slave carries around a copper pitcher of scented water, and a copper bowl; the last with a double, perforated bottom, which allows the soiled water to escape into the lower part where it is hidden. . Handing a towel to each person he pours water ~~on~~ ^{into} their hands, catching it in the bowl.

The room is always filled with servants. When distinguished are present the sons of the host act as waiters. Each dish is served as a separate course beginning with soup and ending with fruits. Jellies and sweet meats alternate with dishes of meat and vegetables.

Each person rises as he finishes except the host, whom etiquette requires to remain eating as long as a guest remain.

After the meal is over, the stool and waiter are removed; cushions are brought in, and stretching out upon the soft heavy Persian carpet you spend the evening drinking many cups of coffee and smoking longstem ^{pipes}.

(27.)

So great is the hospitality of the Egyptian that he can never be induced under any circumstances to accept pay for entertaining a guest under his roof. Consequently hotels are unknown, and the Egyptian who goes from home even for a day takes with him a servant, bedding, cooking utensils, and water-jugs and provisions, so that, should he fail to find a friend at his destination, he may rent a space 10x12 upon the floor of some vacant building for his bed room, the servant erecting a temporary kitchen in a corner of the court-yard. All of his pots, pans, bowls, pitchers and tubs are of beaten copper, lasting for ages

The houses have flat roofs and here in the soft balmy evening air life in Egypt assumes a rose-colored hue. There after sunset the family lounge, smoking, drinking coffee, playing games, telling stories and looking down upon the passers-by.

The life of the Egyptian is extremely indolent. He retires soon after dark and rises at daylight to the call to prayer from some neighboring mosque. He spends the day drinking coffee, smoking, sleeping, reading the Koran and praying.

When the bustling European Tourist goes into his shop to make a purchase, he invites him to sit down; spreads a carpet for him; gives him a cushion; smiles benignly, pats him on the back affectionately; hands him a cup of coffee; gives him a pipe, and invites him to smoke—to pull off his shoes—to take a nap. He himself joins in these past times.

After the napping if the customer is impatient, he exhibits his wares protesting against the haste saying life is too short to hurry through it; He has an abstracted air, names the price mechanically, comes down

(28.)

one half on the slightest intimation to do so, and dismisses his customer with the blessings of God and the Prophet—and pockets three times the value of the article.

In the Egyptian are found some of the most beautiful traits of character and some of the meanest. He is a strange compound.

His leading characteristic is his ~~family~~^{religious} pride. He is early taught to despise the Christian and the Jew; and he consigns to perdition all who are not followers of the Prophet.

Two short articles express his faith;— “There is no deity but God; Mahomet is God’s Apostle.”

The Koran enjoins four great duties: prayer, alms-giving, fasting, and pilgrimage.

He believes Mahomet to be the greatest ^{+ last} ^ of the 6 great prophets. The others are Adam, Noah, Abraham, Moses, and Jesus.

He speaks of our Savior as “Seyyidna Esa”—literally, “our Lord Jesus.” The Koran enjoins him never to mention his name without adding “On whom be Peace.”

All Moslems ^{of Egypt} ^ believe our Savior to have been born of a pure virgin by the miraculous operation of God, without any natural father; and to be the Messiah, and the word of God, which he transmitted to Mary. But they deny his Divinity.

They also believe he was taken up to heaven away from the Jews who sought to kill him; and that they sacrificed another in his stead; that he will come again upon Earth to perfect the Moslem religion.

(29.)

The Egyptian's idea of Heaven is a place where he will have running water, delicious music, sweet odors, plenty of servants and a host of wives, who always remain young, [^] pretty and agreeable. Some writers maintain that it is the Moslem belief that women have no souls, and are therefore incapable of entering Paradise. But this is a mistake. Though he treats his wife shabbily in this life, he is gallant enough to say that Heaven is impossible without woman.

He regards cleanliness as the key to Paradise. He washes his hands and face, and rinses out his mouth before each prayer, saying "whiten my face oh God with thy light"—and dashing the water up in his nostrils, And let me not smell the smells of the fires of Hell.

When called to prayer, he spreads his carpet, or his gown upon the ground, takes off his shoes, and facing in the direction of Mecca prostrates himself upon the ground, ~~and~~ goes through a variety of 8 reflections accurately prescribed by the Koran, repeating his prayers sometime in a loud voice and sometimes in silence.

You see him praying in the Mosque, in the street, by the roadside, in the fields, and in the railway train.

His attitudes are full of humility, and his motions exceedingly graceful.

The call to prayer sung from the Minarets of the great Royal Mosques of Cairo, especially when heard in the deep silence of the hour just preceding daylight, is solemn and melodious. The Mizzien stands in a balcony near the top of the minaret and is thus elevated high above the surrounding buildings.

(30.)

His morning call to prayer is: "God is most great: I testify that there is no deity but God: I testify that Mohamet is God's Apostle: Come to prayer: Come to security: Prayer is better than sleep: To God belongeth Praise and Dominion: He never sleepeth: He shall never die."

Besides these regular appointed times the Egyptian is continually lifting his eyes and voice in prayer.

He prays when he sneezes; he prays when he yawns; he prays when he takes a wife; he prays when he divorces her; and the beggar instead of importuning you gets before your door and prays in a loud voice for God to send him his supper.

The cook as she kills a chicken for dinner says "God give thee patience to endure the affliction which he hath allotted thee"; the washerwoman in rinsing out her clothes says "oh God cleanse my soul from all impurities"; the night watchman calls the hour of the night with "I extol the perfection of the Living King who sleepeth not nor dieth"; "In the name of God let go the anchor" is the order that brings to the stately ship of war. "In the name of God Forward March," is the order that sets the Regiment in motion.

Provoked by the Christian doctrine of the Trinity, he emphasizes the unity of the God Head.

Over the door of his shop and his office; at the street corners, in the Coffee Shops, woven into his carpets, embroidered into his curtains, table covers, and bed covering; upon the little page of his books,
and

and in the mottos of his newspapers you read "There is but one God: He has no Companion, nor wife, nor Son": and the policeman [page ripped] well as he passes under the Christian's [page ripped] is "wahad"—One, meaning there is but one [page ripped]

The Egyptian is a fatalist. "All these rifled ^{steel}-cannon and breech-loading ~~guns~~ rifles are an insult to God" said an Egyptian [page ripped] during the Abyssinian War; if God wants us to whip the Abyssinians we will [page ripped] without these; let us trust in him."

He is a Stoic. He is neither dismayed by adversity, nor elated at prosperity. The reception of the most startling and calamitous news, or of the greatest good fortune is received ~~with~~ⁱⁿ the same calm quiet manner. You never hear him complain of misfortune or boast of good luck.

Pride of blood or of descent is another trait of his character. Is it not enough that he is an Arab and descended from Ismael, and ~~that~~ Abrahan; and that Mohamet is his countryman?

The Egyptian is not suited to the XIXth Century. He is a relic of the past; of the days when men dwelt in huts, travelled on camels, and lived hundreds of years.

Steam, electricity and the telephone he regards as devices of the Devil. He never takes his seat in a railroad car without a mental protest; and a time-table predicting future movements of trains, he looks upon as a standing insult to the Most High.

He is a bundle of contradictions. Suddenly confronted with death, he shows neither [page ripped] nor emotion; yet he lives in constant fear of ghosts evil spirits and devils.

The soldier condemned to be shot at sunrise passes the evening smoking, sipping coffee, and listening to Arabian Night stories, and [page ripped] his usual night's sleep. Yet so great is his [page ripped] his fear is the dark that it is impossible to [page ripped] night pickets in front of an Egyptian Army [page ripped] Campaign.

He is full of benevolence and charity, but is avaricious and envious to a high degree. His humanity to dumb animals is beautiful; yet when his wife gets old, blind and bed-ridden, he can turn her out into the streets to die without the slightest twinge of conscience.

He never forgets to be polite and affable; is honest in the payment of his debts; his hospitality is lavish and free; but nothing you could for him could elicit the smallest spark of gratitude.

He will swear by the Prophet that he is selling below cost, while asking you double price; yet he will never deceive you in the quality of the article; nor cheat you in measure or weight.

He is a mystery. The longer you know him the less you understand him.